

2 MILLION +
COPIES SOLD
WORLDWIDE!

THE COMPOUND EFFECT IN BUSINESS

BRAND & **DESIGN** SYSTEM

The visual system for The Compound Effect in Business, taken from the printed jacket and the pages and trailer built for the launch: marks, colour, type, components and web standards.

GOVERNS EVERY TCEB ASSET, PRINT AND WEB

V1.0 - OCTOBER 2026

DARREN HARDY

THE LOCKUP

The primary identity is the **title lockup as printed on the jacket**: THE, COMPOUND and EFFECT stacked, with IN BUSINESS in red on its own line. It is artwork cut from the jacket file, not type. Use the supplied files only; never retype it.



WHITE · ON BLACK AND PHOTOGRAPHIC GROUNDS



BLACK · ON WHITE GROUNDS

CLEAR SPACE & MINIMUM SIZE



Keep clear space on all four sides equal to at least **the cap height of COMPOUND**. Minimum width: **160 px** on screen, **1.25 in** in print, so THE stays legible. Below that, set the title as one line of text. Artwork is 1600 px wide, cut at 600 dpi from the jacket.

DO

- White on black or photographic grounds.
- Black on white grounds.
- Keep IN BUSINESS red, smaller than EFFECT, on its own line.
- Preserve proportions and clear space.

DON'T

- Retype it in any face.
- Turn COMPOUND or EFFECT red or gold.
- Stretch, condense, rotate, outline or add shadows.
- Place it on mid-grey, cream or tinted grounds.
- Set it at equal weight with DARREN HARDY in one view.

LOGO VARIANTS & PARENT BRAND

Four units in a fixed order: author, franchise, book. The lockup is the identity. The franchise lockup carries the equity of two million copies. His name is set as the jacket sets it, and the DH mark closes every page.

IN BUSINESS LOCKUP · PRIMARY IDENTITY

THE
COMPOUND
EFFECT
IN BUSINESS

THE
COMPOUND
EFFECT

THE COMPOUND EFFECT · FRANCHISE

DARREN HARDY

AUTHOR NAME · JACKET BAND



DH PARENT MARK · FOOTER

AUTHOR IMAGE

The jacket's back-flap photograph is **the approved image of Darren for TCEB**. Use the jacket version linked here, not the sharpened DH_sept_16–3. A rectangle only: never a circle, a cut-out or a new background. He stays on his own dark office set. His body angles to the left of frame, so he sits to the right of the copy. On a black hero, fade the photo into black from the copy side (as on the launch pages) so he and the headline share one field.

Air · DH GO-TO PICS · DH Author Photo – TCEB Jacket Version · 2752 × 1536 · [Open in Air](#)



HIERARCHY RULE

The lockup leads in the hero. The DH mark sits in the footer. His name in Franklin appears only in byline positions. Two units never share one view at equal weight.

FILE NAMING CONVENTION

The pattern to follow when you save or export a mark: brand, unit, colour.

tceb-lockup-white.png · primary, on dark

tceb-lockup-black.png · primary, on white

tce-lockup-white/black.png · franchise

dh-name-black/white.png · author name

dh-mark-white/dark.webp · parent mark

COLOR SYSTEM

Two hard grounds, one red, and a gold that never leaves the dark. The jacket is pure black against pure white, and the hardness of that edge is the identity.

No creams, no tinted paper, no third ground.

RED ON WHITE

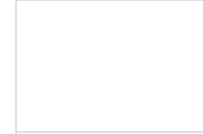
The book. White owns the book, every primary CTA, the argument and the moneylines.

GOLD ON BLACK

The dark register. On black, gold is the accent: the solid button, big numbers, stars, the glow. #D4A017 never crosses onto white.

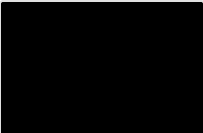
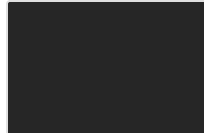
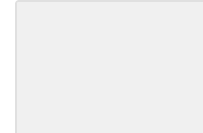
The rule that governs every page: the jacket is black, so a book page cannot be. Put the black book on white and it lands; put it on black and it disappears. That is also why the trailer ends on white.

THE ACCENT

					
Red #E1132E on white	Red bright* #FF0047 type on black	Print red C12 M100 Y92 K3	Gold† #D4A017 black only	Gold lux† #CAA76A softer register	White #FFFFFF ground

*Red bright is type only, never a button fill (white on it is 3.93:1). †Gold lives on black only: 2.38:1 on white fails at every size. Print red is the jacket's process build; the screen reds are matched for contrast, not converted from it.

NEUTRALS

					
Black #000000 web ground	Jacket black K100 · #231F20 print	Ink #262626 body on white	Grey #6E6E6E fine print	Silver #B3B3B3 body on black	Field #F0F0F0 callouts only

Greys are type tiers and rules, not grounds. The one surface allowed is Field, behind a callout or spec table. The copy seal is jacket grey #A7A5A6 and appears nowhere else.

ACCESSIBILITY

Red on white 4.85:1 and red bright on black 5.34:1 both carry body text. #E1132E on black is 4.33:1, large type only. Gold on black 8.84:1. Gold beside red at the same size vibrates (only 1.65:1 apart): separate them by size, weight or space. One red per view; long stretches with no colour are what make it land.

TYPOGRAPHY

Read off the jacket file, not assumed. Two families, used the way the jacket uses them: Bebas Neue Pro for the title, ITC Franklin Gothic for his name and the reading copy. On screen, Inter carries body and UI. Hierarchy comes from width, weight and size. Every title sample below is cut from the jacket itself.

TITLE

Bebas Neue Pro SemiExpanded Bold ·
UPPER · tracked open

COMPOUND

HERO WORD

Bebas Neue Pro Expanded Bold ·
EFFECT only

EFFECT

THE TAIL

SemiExpanded Bold · red · about half
the size of EFFECT

IN BUSINESS

AUTHOR NAME

ITC Franklin Gothic Std Demi
Condensed · his name only

DARREN HARDY

SUBTITLE & FLAP COPY

ITC Franklin Gothic Std Book
Compressed · Demi Compressed for
flap emphasis

MULTIPLY YOUR PROFITS,
YOUR PEOPLE, YOUR ADVANTAGE

WEB BODY & UI

Inter 400 / 600 / 700 · sentence case

Your business is already compounding. The only question is: **in which direction?**

WEB TYPE SCALE

ROLE	FACE	WEIGHT	SIZE	LINE	TRACKING	CASE
Display (one per page)	Bebas Neue Pro SemiExp	Light → Bold	clamp(42–96px)	0.94	0.02em	UPPER
Section	Bebas Neue Pro SemiExp	Bold	clamp(32–60px)	0.98	0.02em	UPPER
Card / tier (Bebas floor)	Bebas Neue Pro SemiExp	Bold	28–34px	1.0	0.03em	UPPER
Lede / body	Inter	400	17–20 / 17px	1.62 / 1.72	0	Sentence
Label / button / tag	Inter	700	11–14px	1.3	0.08em	UPPER
Fine print	Inter	400	12px	1.55	0	Sentence

Weight range, not one weight: Light carries the setup, Bold lands the one line that must land. **Bebas never below 28px:** it turns spindly, so labels and buttons are Inter 700. **ALL CAPS: eight words maximum**, six preferred. Franklin Demi Condensed is for his name only.

BUTTONS & UI MARKS

Two CTA styles. Uppercase Inter 700, 2 px radius (near square, like the jacket), one primary action per view. On white the solid is **red**; on black the solid is **gold** with black type.

GET ON THE LIST →

Solid · red fill, white type. A soft neutral shadow, no darker edge.

SEE THE BOOK →

Ghost · ink outline and type. Fills ink on hover, type flips white.

RECURRING MARKS

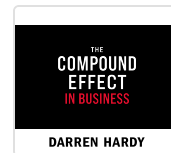
The small repeated elements that carry the brand. There is no icon library; these are the signatures.



COPY SEAL · JACKET GREY

OWNERSHIP.

THE RED PERIOD



THE BAND

PLAY BUTTONS



GOLD · DARK THUMBS



RED · ANY THUMB



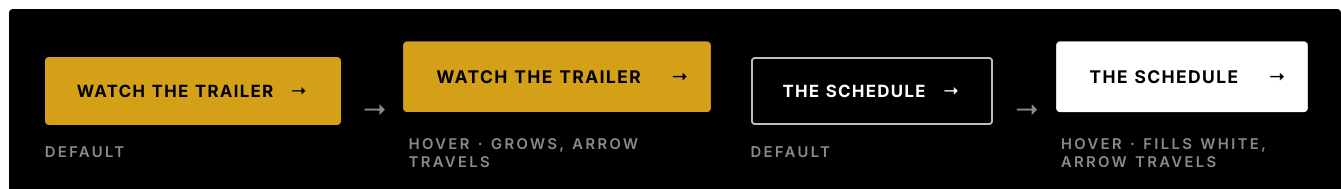
WHITE · DARK OR MID THUMBS



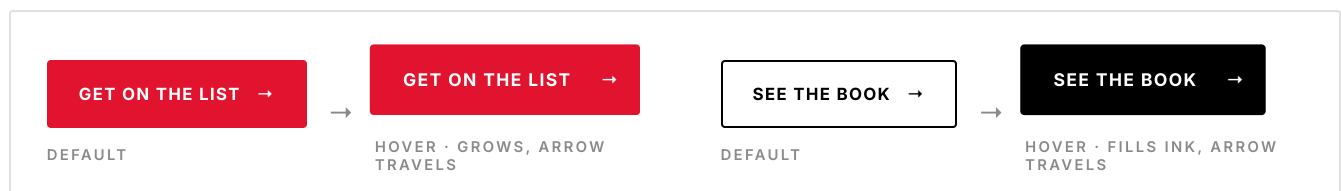
INK · LIGHT THUMBS

All four colours sit on photo and video thumbnails. The button lives in a **bottom corner, left or right** (whichever keeps it off the subject) and **never covers a face**. Choose the colour by the tone of that corner: gold or white on dark, ink on light, red on anything. The halo ring grows on hover. Video never loads with the page: the play opens a lightbox, the player is created on click and removed on close (youtube-nocookie, Vimeo dnt=1).

BUTTON STATES · BLACK GROUND



BUTTON STATES · WHITE GROUND

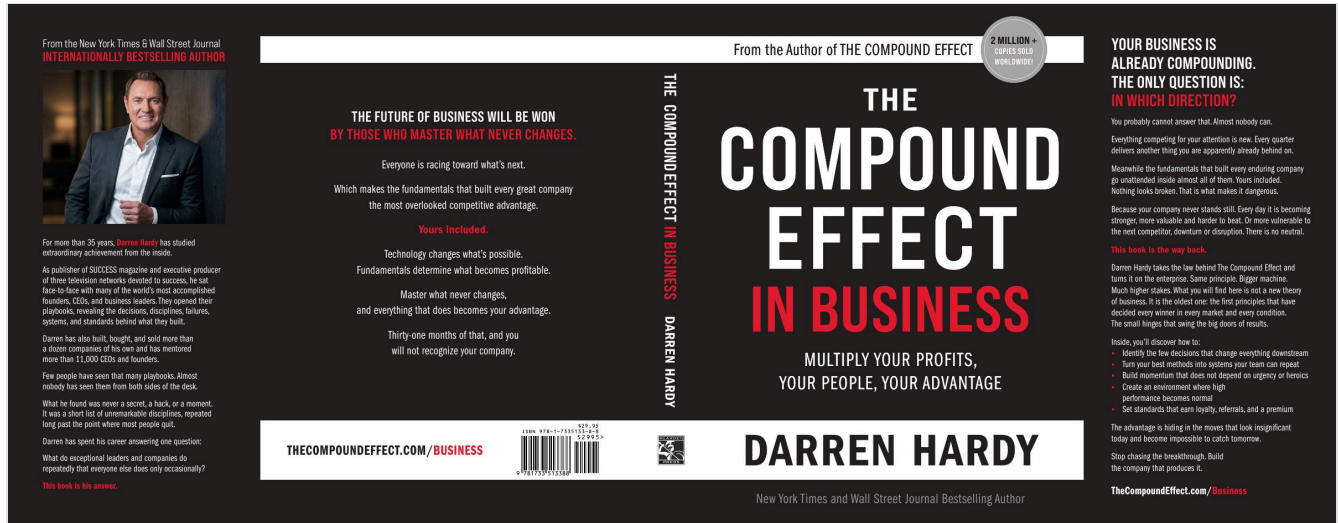


Nothing darkens on hover. A solid holds its fill: it grows about 4%, lifts 3 px and the arrow travels. A ghost fills with its own type colour and flips the type to the ground.

COMPONENTS & TREATMENTS

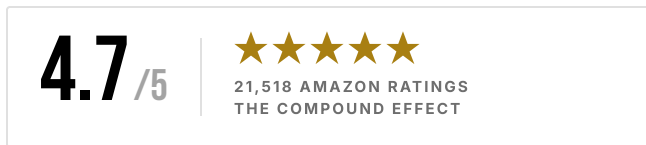
The repeatable building blocks, as built on the launch pages and in the trailer.

THE JACKET · FULL SPREAD (6 OCT 2026)



Back flap, back, spine, front, front flap: the source of every mark, colour and face here. TCEB-Cover-Jacket_10-6.pdf.

RATING LOCKUP · AMAZON

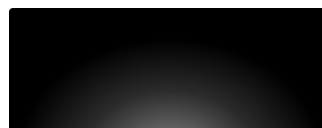


Always name the source and the book: these are the 2010 book's ratings and never attach to TCEB's own claims. Read 4 Oct 2026; re-check before each use. Stars: ink-gold #A87F12 on white, gold on black.

THE GLOW · BACKGROUND ONLY



GOLD · ON BLACK



SILVER · ON BLACK



RED · ON BLACK



SHADOW · ON WHITE

Gold from below is the signature (in the trailer, the audience). Silver is the neutral light on black. Red glows on black only, fading through deep red, never clear. On white a glow becomes a shadow; never a red glow on white (it turns pink).

ELEVATION

Borders over shadows on cards. Real shadows only under objects (the book, a solid button's lift). 2 px radius, near square like the jacket; circles only for play buttons and the seal.

CREDENTIAL BAND · GOLD ON BLACK



Open-ended credentials only. Numbers count up once on entry.

MOTION & THE BOOK

Arrivals rise 38 px over 0.9 s. Black to white is the signature transition, and the pace compounds toward the reveal. The book is a real hardback that **always faces the copy**.

WEB IMPLEMENTATION

The tokens to build from. Reference variables; never hard-code raw hex inside a component. The live `tceb.css` still carries the pre-jacket red `#E02826`: swap it for `#E1132E` on its next pass.

```
/* Design tokens. The :root every TCEB page reads */
:root {
  /* grounds */
  --c-white:#ffffff; --c-black:#000000; --c-ink:#141414; --c-surface-d:#131313;
  /* zone 1, the book: red. one per view */
  --c-red:#e1132e; --c-red-bright:#ff0047; /* bright = type on black only */
  /* the dark register: gold. black grounds only */
  --c-gold:#d4a017; --c-gold-lux:#caa76a; --c-gold-ink:#8a6300; /* only gold allowed on white */
  /* type */
  --font-display:'Bebas Neue Pro','Bebas Neue','Oswald',sans-serif;
  --font-name:'ITC Franklin Gothic Std','Archivo Narrow',sans-serif;
  --font-body:'Inter',-apple-system,'Segoe UI',sans-serif;
  --radius:2px; --container:1080px; --gutter:32px;
}
```

LAYOUT & SPACING

Container max **1080 px**; side gutter 32 px desktop, 20 px mobile. Sections breathe at 120–160 px on desktop; a uniform 72 px on mobile. Mobile is its own design: sticky bottom action bar, bottom-sheet modals, snap-scrolling card rails, 44 px touch targets.

ACCENT LOGIC (LOAD-BEARING)

Red on white, gold on black. Components never hard-code a ground: they read `--fg`, `--surface`, `--accent`, which flip inside `.ground-black` and `.on-dark`.

ACCESSIBILITY

Body at 4.5:1 or better. Visible focus, real alt text, prefers-reduced-motion honoured. Scroll reveals must leave everything visible if the observer never fires.

PERFORMANCE

Self-host every font as woff2 (no Google Fonts, no CDN). WebP, sized to at most 2× its rendered box. Lazy-load below the fold. Video only on click. Every page noindex until it launches.

ANY BLACK SECTION

Black ground, gold accent. Add the dark class to the section, never only a dark background (that gives dark-on-dark type).

```
.ground-black, .on-dark { /* black ground, gold accent */
  --bg:var(--c-black); --fg:var(--c-white); --accent:var(--c-red-bright); --gold-type:var(--c-gold);
}
em { font-style:normal; color:var(--accent); } /* gold em on black */
```

EMPHASIS & WORD CRAFT

How words earn weight without italics. Two mechanics only: a colour shift and a weight shift. Both apply at headline and body size.

RULE 1 · NEVER ITALICS

The `<em>` element marks emphasis semantically; its italic is overridden. No exceptions: the jacket sets even **New York Times** upright.

RULE 2 · ONE COLOUR SHIFT PER HEADLINE

Emphasis renders red on white, red bright on black, and gold where the section is black. One per headline, one per view where possible. The jacket spends its red on a phrase or two per panel, never a paragraph; that discipline is why it lands.

RULE 3 · LIGHT SETS UP, BOLD ANSWERS

The weight shift carries the argument. The setup is light; the answer is bold. Proven in the trailer: the question types in light and the turn lands in bold.

WHAT ABOUT
MY BUSINESS? |

RULE 4 · THE RED PERIOD

A short statement may end on a red full stop. It is the smallest dose of the accent, so it can sit on a line that already has no other colour. Never alongside a red word in the same line.

IT COMPOUNDS.

RULE 5 · PUNCTUATION OUTSIDE THE EM

`<em>In Business</em>. not <em>In Business.</em> When two phrases share a connector, each gets its own em and the connector stays neutral. The red period is the only punctuation that is coloured, and it is the em.`

RULE 6 · THE COPY RULES TRAVEL WITH THE TYPE

- No em dashes, anywhere, comments included.
- ALL CAPS: eight words maximum.
- Customers invest. Transaction verbs never appear.
- Credentials stay open-ended: "more than 35 years," never an exact count.
- "Leader," not "owner." Never open on the reader's problem.
- Never promise a number, a growth rate or a timeline.

BRAND TERM PROTECTION · .NOBREAK

Multi-word marks never break across lines: The Compound Effect, IN BUSINESS, Darren Hardy, BMC|COLLECTIVE.

```
em { font-style:normal; color:var(--accent); }      /* colour only, never slant */
.answer { font-weight:700; } .setup { font-weight:300; }
.stop { color:var(--accent); }                      /* <span class="stop">.</span> */
.nobreak { white-space:nowrap; }
```

CTA SYSTEM

Two button variants share identical dimensions and motion; only the paint differs. Use them deliberately, based on what the moment asks of the visitor.

.BTN-SOLID · DEMANDS ACTION

Filled: red with white type on white grounds, gold with black type on black. One flat fill, lifted by a soft neutral shadow. The **primary** or **closing** CTA, one per view: the final commit point of a page.

.BTN-GHOST · INVITES WITHOUT PRESSURE

Outlined in the ground's type colour. On hover it fills with that colour and the type flips to the ground. For the nav and secondary slots, where presence matters more than the click.

```
/* Shared dimensions, font, padding, motion */
.btn-solid, .btn-ghost {
  display:inline-flex; align-items:center; gap:14px;
  padding:20px 36px; border-radius:var(--radius); border:1.5px solid transparent;
  font-family:var(--font-body); font-weight:700; font-size:13px;
  letter-spacing:.08em; text-transform:uppercase; text-decoration:none;
  transition:transform .22s cubic-bezier(.2,.8,.2,1), box-shadow .22s;
}
/* Only the paint differs. The fill never changes on hover. */
.btn-solid { background:var(--c-red); color:#fff; box-shadow:0 10px 22px rgba(0,0,0,.16); }
.on-dark .btn-solid { background:var(--c-gold); color:#000; box-shadow:0 10px 22px rgba(0,0,0,.5); }
.btn-solid:hover { transform:translateY(-3px) scale(1.04); }
.btn-solid:active { transform:translateY(5px); transition-duration:60ms; }
.btn-ghost { background:transparent; color:var(--fg); border-color:var(--fg); }
.btn-ghost:hover { background:var(--fg); color:var(--bg); }
/* The arrow travels on both */
.btn-solid .arw, .btn-ghost .arw { transition:transform .22s; }
.btn-solid:hover .arw, .btn-ghost:hover .arw { transform:translateX(6px); }
```

A page can host both: a ghost in the nav (a low-pressure invite) and a solid at the close (the actual decision). Every button carries the → arrow, which travels 6 px on hover. Never two solids in one view, never a coloured glow under a button (a blurred red shadow reads pink), never a pill shape, and never a label in Bebas at button size.

NOTE ON THE LIVE STYLESHEET

tceb.css still darkens .btn-red on hover (to --c-red-deep). That predates the rule above and should be brought into line on the next pass of the stylesheet.

From the Author of THE COMPOUND EFFECT

2 MILLION +
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THE COMPOUND EFFECT IN BUSINESS

MULTIPLY YOUR PROFITS,
YOUR PEOPLE, YOUR ADVANTAGE

DARREN HARDY

New York Times and Wall Street Journal Bestselling Author



Every asset that carries this title should feel as **deliberate, hard-edged** and **certain** as the jacket it comes from. When in doubt: a white ground, the black book, one red.